

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 20, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 6:1—11

1 Dare any of you, having a matter against another, go to law before the unrighteous, and not before the saints?

2 Do you not know that the saints will judge the world? And if the world will be judged by you, are you unworthy to judge the smallest matters?

3 Do you not know that we shall judge angels? How much more, things that pertain to this life?

4 If then you have judgments concerning things pertaining to this life, do you appoint those who are least esteemed by the church to judge?

5 I say this to your shame. Is it so, that there is not a wise man among you, not even one, who will be able to judge between his brethren?

6 But brother goes to law against brother, and that before unbelievers!

7 Now therefore, it is already an utter failure for you that you go to law against one another. Why do you not rather accept wrong? Why do you not rather let yourselves be cheated?

8 No, you yourselves do wrong and cheat, and you do these things to your brethren!

9 Do you not know that the unrighteous will not inherit the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived. Neither fornicators, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor homosexuals, nor sodomites,

10 nor thieves, nor covetous, nor drunkards, nor revilers, nor extortioners will inherit the kingdom of God.

11 And such were some of you. But you were washed, but you were sanctified, but you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus and by the Spirit of our God.

II. Key Summary

- Paul was shocked that believers were dragging each other before pagan courts — not just because of the conflict itself, but because of how badly it damaged the church's credibility in the eyes of outsiders.
 - He argues that accepting wrong is better than winning an argument at the cost of the community; the real loss isn't the money or the property — it's the spectacle of Christians fighting in public.
 - Verse 11 is the turning point of the whole passage: "And such were some of you. But you were washed, sanctified, justified." Our identity has been transformed, and that is the true foundation for how we handle every conflict.
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III. Passage Analysis

Choosing to Take the Loss Can Be the Greater Win

"It would be better to accept wrong. It would be better to let yourselves be cheated than to defend your 'rights' at the expense of God's glory and the higher good of His kingdom. Paul called this man to do something hard: to give up what he deserved for the higher good of God and His kingdom." [1]

Paul's point isn't who is right or wrong — it's that some things matter more than winning: the health of your relationships and the reputation of your community. Choosing to absorb a loss can sometimes speak louder than any court ruling.

"Such Were Some of You" — You Are Not Who You Used to Be

"'Such were some of you' contrasts past depravity with present identity — producing humility by remembering one's former spiritual condition, and generating gratitude for God's transformative grace." [2]

Paul isn't dragging up the past to shame anyone — he's using it to show how far grace has reached. The three words washed, sanctified, justified aren't goals to work toward; they describe what God has already done. Your identity has genuinely changed.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever been in a conflict where you were totally in the right, but pushing for your win ended up hurting the relationship more than the original issue did — what did you do with that?

If who you are has already been changed by something outside yourself, does that shift how you want to handle it next time?

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-6/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Multiple Commentators,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/6-11.htm